PTA
Parent Teacher Association

ARENA SCHOOL

PTA PARENT COFFEE · OCTOBER 14, 2026

Our Kids' Jobs *Don't Exist Yet.*

So Which Skills Will Matter?

From what's changing at work *to what you can do at home.*



1

Work is being rewritten

Even in the safest careers



2

Three skills decide who gets ahead

Agency, taste, and craft



3

What families can do now

Three takeaways

We trained at ISB, Caltech, Harvard, Brown, and Tsinghua, then did *the jobs AI is now automating.*



Jing Jing Yang

ISB CLASS OF 2019

Advises Chinese AI firms, including Kimi, on going global

STUDIED INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校 · BROWN · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED · Deloitte. · CICC 中金公司



Phillip An

FORBES 30 UNDER 30
Y COMBINATOR ALUM

Co-founder and CEO of Skylarq, AI agents for sales

STUDIED Caltech · HARVARD · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED Goldman Sachs · McKinsey&Company

THE QUESTION BEHIND TODAY'S TALK

When AI can draft an essay in seconds, what must our children *still learn to do?*

SECTION 1

AI is already changing work, *including the careers families trust most.*

1 Work is being rewritten
Even in the safest careers

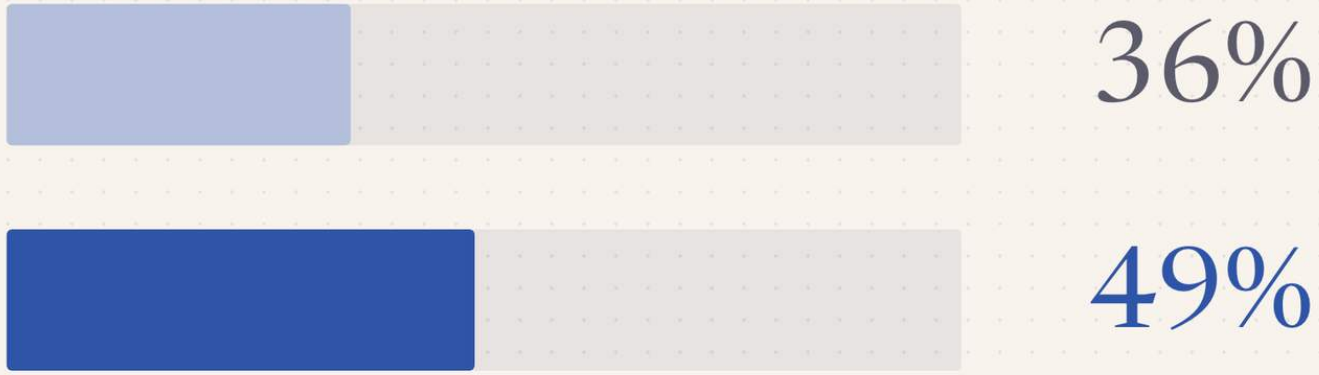
2 Three skills decide who gets ahead
Agency, taste, and craft

3 What families can do now
Three takeaways

In about half of all jobs, AI is already used for *at least a quarter of the tasks.*

ANTHROP\C

Occupations where AI is used in at least a quarter of tasks

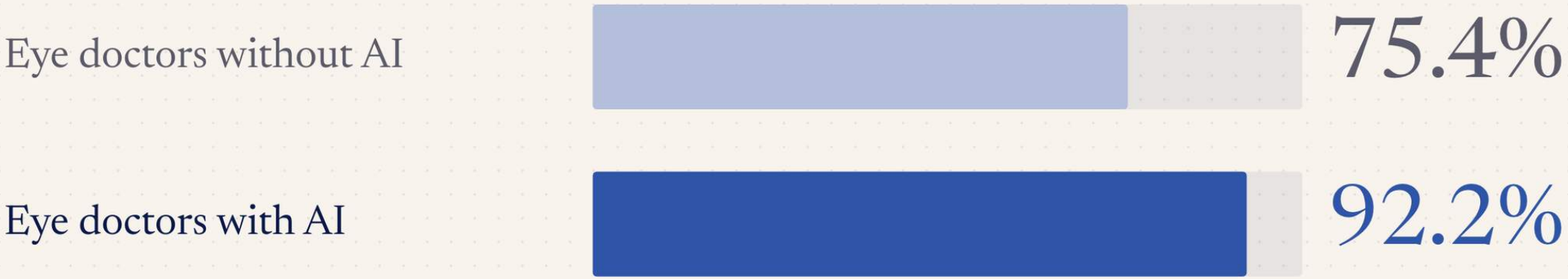


Anthropic Economic Index, Jan 15, 2026: share of occupations using AI for at least 25% of their tasks (36% in the January 2025 report). The 2026 figure pools data across reports and reflects how people use Claude, not a census of every worker.

With AI, eye doctors got the diagnosis right *92% of the time. Without it, 75%.*

THE EYEFM TRIAL · NATURE MEDICINE

Patients given the correct diagnosis



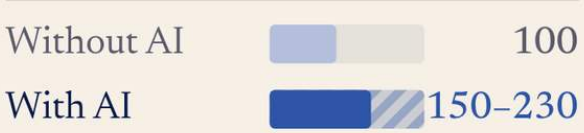
Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Tsinghua University, and others, Nature Medicine, Aug 28, 2025: 668 patients and 16 eye doctors at one centre, retinal screening; correct referrals also rose, from 80.5% to 92.2%

Law students using AI got *50% to 130% more done* on most legal tasks.

A US RANDOMIZED TRIAL

+50–130%

more work done with AI, on 5 of 6 legal tasks



LAWYERS IN MAINLAND CHINA

93%

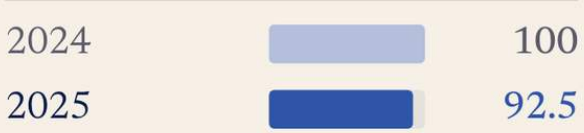
of lawyers and trainees already use AI at work



LARGE US LAW FIRMS

−7.5%

new-graduate lawyers hired in 2025, the first drop since 2014



Schwarcz, Manning, Prescott, and others, “AI-Powered Lawyering”, 137 law students, 2026; LexisNexis survey of 404 legal professionals in mainland China, via Caixin, Aug 29, 2025; NALP, Class of 2025, Aug 5, 2026, which does not attribute the drop to AI alone

At ICBC, China's biggest bank, AI did work equal to *about 13% of its staff* in 2025.

55,000 person-years

ICBC

of work done by AI "digital employees", at a bank with 409,758 staff

7,800 roles

standard chartered

in corporate functions to go by 2030, replacing what its CEO called "lower-value human capital."

ICBC 2025 Annual Report, March 27, 2026 (13% is our calculation); Standard Chartered investor event, May 19, 2026: 15% of corporate-function roles; Bill Winters later apologised for the wording

Companies are already acting. Amazon has cut *about 30,000 corporate jobs.*

amazon

JUNE 17, 2025

The CEO's memo

AI "will reduce our total corporate workforce"

OCTOBER 28, 2025

14,000

corporate roles cut

JANUARY 28, 2026

16,000

more corporate roles cut

Amazon: Andy Jassy memo, June 17, 2025; workforce memos, Oct 28, 2025 and Jan 28, 2026. Amazon also cited cutting layers of management, and Jassy later said the October cuts were "not even really AI-driven."

“Those who embrace this change, become conversant in AI … will be well-positioned to *have high impact.*”

amazon

Andy Jassy, CEO of Amazon

Memo to employees, June 17, 2025

WHAT THE SKILLS ARE WORTH · PWC 2026 GLOBAL AI JOBS BAROMETER

The pay gap is already here: jobs that require AI skills pay *62% more.*

62%

PWC

higher advertised pay for jobs that require AI skills



PwC 2026 Global AI Jobs Barometer, June 15, 2026: average wage premium in job ads across 27 countries; it does not control for education or experience

In the most exposed jobs, young people are already *19% behind.*

AGES 22 TO 25

−19%

employment in AI-exposed jobs, against peers their age in less-exposed jobs

EXPERIENCED WORKERS

No gap

in the same AI-exposed jobs

Brynjolfsson, Chandar, and Chen, “Canaries in the Coal Mine?”, revised August 2026; descriptive, not a causal estimate

In China, 81% of students say AI skills make them more competitive, yet *40% of them haven't started.*

MYCOS 麦可思

SAY AI SKILLS MAKE THEM MORE COMPETITIVE

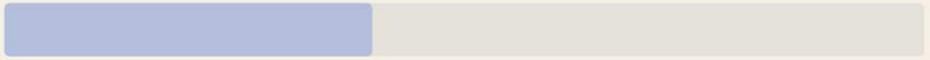
81%



YET

OF THOSE, HAVEN'T STARTED LEARNING YET

40%



MyCOS online survey, March 19–20, 2026, published April 16, 2026

SECTION 2

So three skills now decide who gets ahead: *agency, taste, and craft.*

1 Work is being rewritten
Even in the safest careers

2 Three skills decide who gets ahead
Agency, taste, and craft

3 What families can do now
Three takeaways

AI is making the how cheap: writing code, drafts, *and analysis.*

75%

GOOGLE

of new code is now drafted by AI, then approved by engineers

80%

GITHUB

of new developers use Copilot in their first week, so writing code is no longer the scarce step

Sundar Pichai, up from 50% last fall, Google Cloud Next / company blog, April 22, 2026. GitHub Octoverse 2025: nearly 80% of new developers used Copilot in week one

So value moves to what to do, *and whether it's good.*

HOW TO DO IT

Write the code

Draft the memo

Run the analysis

WHAT · WHETHER IT'S GOOD

Decide what to build

Judge the output

Lead people and AI

ESSENTIAL NOW · RISING THROUGH 2030



WEF Future of Jobs 2025, Jan 7, 2025, Fig. 3.3 essential now; Fig. 3.4 rising through 2030. Microsoft 2026 Work Trend Index; LinkedIn Skills on the Rise 2026

Agency, taste, and craft, plus creativity and leadership, *each have a job.*

ARENA'S THREE SKILLS

01

Agency

Decide what is worth building before anyone assigns it

02

Taste

Judge whether the output is actually good

03

Craft

Finish it so people can trust it

ALSO ON EMPLOYERS' LISTS · WEF

04

Creativity

Find a new answer when the obvious one is cheap

05

Leadership

Direct people and AI toward the same goal

The same AI can hand a child the answer or help them understand it. *Habits decide which.*

SHORTCUT

"Just give me the answer."

The homework gets done. The thinking gets skipped.

TUTOR

"Explain it until I get it."

The child does the thinking. AI explains and checks.

OECD, PISA 2025 results, Sept 8, 2026: students who used AI chatbots for schoolwork scored lower on average, but frequent users who had been taught to judge AI output did better. A correlation, not proof of cause

WHAT CHILDREN NEED

Skills grow from practice *with structure.*



A real project

with something at stake



A coach

who asks how you checked it



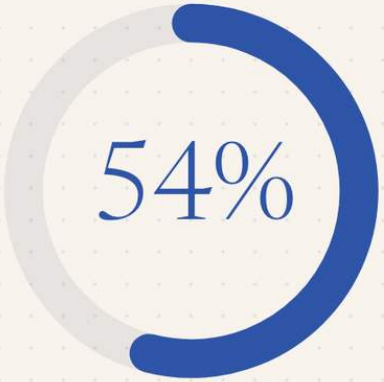
Honest feedback

from real people

Most schools still lack teachers ready to teach AI, *so families start now.*



of schools have too few teachers ready to teach AI



of teachers lack confidence in teaching AI

CNAES survey, 3,653 responses across eastern, central, and western China, May–June 2026, published Aug 19, 2026. In the US, 68% of teachers had no school or district training on AI (Gallup and Walton Family Foundation, 2025).

SECTION 3

So start building these skills now, *while the gap is still small.*

1 Work is being rewritten
Even in the safest careers

2 Three skills decide who gets ahead
Agency, taste, and craft

3 What families can do now
Three takeaways

Takeaway

1

WHAT FAMILIES CAN DO NOW

Know the latest AI tools, *so you can guide your child.*

1 Know the tools | 2 Use AI for real tasks | 3 The best time to build

Who has heard of these? Behind them, *thousands of new AI models appear every day.*

Kimi ● | Muse | Instinct | Manus | Genspark | OpenClaw ●

200 MORE AI TOOLS YOU COULD TRY TODAY

ChatGPT Claude Gemini DeepSeek Doubao Qwen Yuanbao ERNIE Grok Copilot Meta AI Le Chat Perplexity Poe Character.AI Pi ChatGLM MiniMax Hunyuan Spark Baichuan StepFun Skywork Metaso Felo You.com Phind Consensus Elicit Scite NotebookLM Notion AI Gamma Tome Beautiful.ai Pitch Canva Figma Make Framer Webflow Lovable Bolt v0 Replit Cursor Windsurf GitHub Copilot TRAE Claude Code Codex Devin Tabnine Cody Zed Warp JetBrains AI Amazon Q Gemini CLI Qoder CodeBuddy Comate Kiro Midjourney DALL·E Ideogram Leonardo Firefly Stable Diffusion FLUX Krea Recraft Playground Lovart Dreamina Liblib Kolors Wanxiang Sora Veo Runway Pika Luma Kling Hailuo Vidu PixVerse Seedance HeyGen Synthesia D-ID CapCut Descript OpusClip Captions Hedra Higgsfield InVideo Flow Suno Udio ElevenLabs Murf Speechify Otter Fireflies Granola Whisper Krisp AIVA Comet Dia Atlas Flowith Coze Dify n8n Zapier Make Lindy Relevance AI Gumloop CrewAI LangChain AutoGPT Cue WorkBuddy Fellou AutoGLM Grammarly Jasper Copy.ai Writesonic Sudowrite QuillBot Wordtune DeepL Rytr Lex Mem Reflect Superhuman Motion Reclaim Clockwise Fathom tl;dv Read AI Tactiq Zoom AI Slack AI Miro AI Whimsical Napkin Glean Raycast Monica Sider MaxAI Merlin HARPA Khanmigo Duolingo Max Quizlet Photomath Brainly Gauth Question.AI Speak Praktika ELSA MagicSchool Brisk Diffit Curipod SchoolAI Squirrel AI Spline Meshy Tripo Uizard Stitch Visily Relume Hugging Face Supabase Firebase Studio AI Studio OpenRouter Ollama LM Studio Jan Julius Llama Gemma Adobe Express Designer Pictory Lumen5 Notta Plaud

HUGGING FACE

4,386

new AI models published in one day: Monday, October 12, 2026

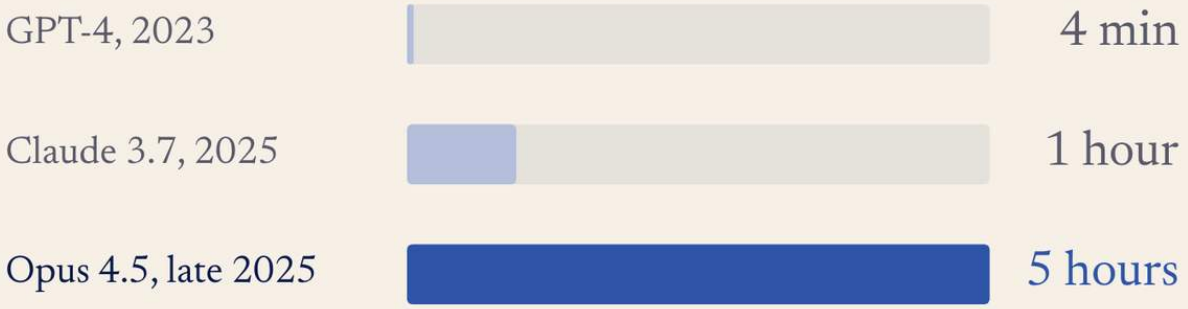
About 3 every minute *3.1 million in all*

Hugging Face Hub API: 4,386 public models created Oct 12, 2026 (UTC); huggingface.co/models lists 3,145,598. Both checked Oct 13, 2026. Tools: each tool's own site

The work AI can finish alone has *doubled about every 7 months.*

METR · 50% TIME HORIZON

Length of work a frontier model can finish on its own



2023
Cursor
an AI code editor launches

JUNE 2024
Kling
Kuaishou's AI video

MARCH 2025
Manus
an agent that finishes many-step tasks

SEPT 2026
Muse
Meta's agent for email and travel

METR, Time Horizon 1.1, Jan 29, 2026: doubled about every 7 months; GPT-4 ~4 min, Claude 3.7 ~1 hour, Opus 4.5 ~5 hours. Cursor 2023; Kling June 2024; Manus March 2025; Muse Sept 2026

Takeaway

2

WHAT FAMILIES CAN DO NOW

Use AI on real tasks with real stakes, *like a school project or a job application.*

1 Know the tools | 2 Use AI for real tasks | 3 The best time to build

For a non-technical role, the candidate who built something before the interview *got the offer.*

THE SITUATION

Hiring for a non-technical role on Kimi's growth team

Jing Jing was interviewing candidates for the team.

→

WHAT ONE CANDIDATE BUILT

A small tool for the team's social media work

Made with AI, on the candidate's own initiative, before the interview.

→

WHAT HAPPENED

Showed it live in the interview, and *got the offer*

A real task for the team, done before anyone asked.

KIMI | *Nobody asked for it. That was the point.*

A first-hand hiring story from Jing Jing Yang, hiring for the growth team at Kimi (Moonshot AI)

Takeaway

3

WHAT FAMILIES CAN DO NOW

Despite all this, it's one of the best times ever to be a kid, *and the best time to build.*

1 Know the tools | 2 Use AI for real tasks | 3 The best time to build

When we were young, ideas stayed in a notebook. Today a child can *make one real.*

WHEN WE WERE YOUNG		TODAY
Built by hand, and slowly	→	AI builds a first version in an afternoon
A team, and years of training	→	One child can launch a first version in a week
Only the family saw what you made	→	Real users, before they leave school

Four MIT friends started Cursor in 2022. SpaceX bought it for *$60 billion.*



2022

Four MIT friends

start an AI coding tool

2023

Cursor launches

an AI code editor

NOV 2025

Series D

valuation, with over $1B annualized revenue

AUG 2026

Acquired by SpaceX

an all-stock deal

Cursor, Series D post, Nov 13, 2025; Reuters, CNBC, and Bloomberg, June 16, 2026; SpaceX Form 8-K and PitchBook, Aug 14, 2026

Arena teaches the 14 tools and four skills *the earlier gaps require.*

FLUENCY · 14 TOOLS FROM ARENA PROGRAMS



ENTREPRENEURSHIP

01 Find a problem

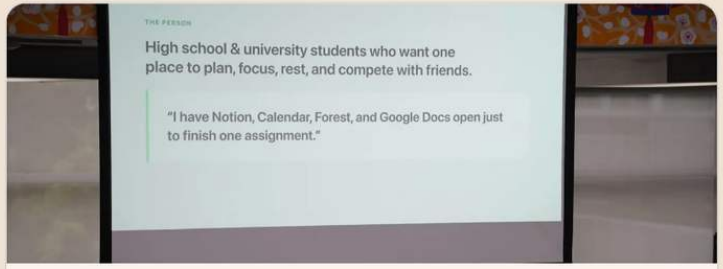
02 Build

03 Get real-user feedback

04 Launch

Fluency, agency, taste, and craft: the tools, then choose, judge, and finish. Teachers are still learning these. Students practice them here.

In one week at ISB, a student team went from a real problem *to a product judges tested.*



PROBLEM *Days 1–2 · choose it, talk to users*

Too many apps for one assignment

"I have Notion, Calendar, Forest, and Google Docs open just to finish one assignment."

Agency · choosing what's worth solving



BUILD *Days 2–4 · live at a link*

One place to plan, focus, rest, and compete with friends

Built with AI coding tools, with mentors asking how each draft was checked.

Taste · telling which version works



RESULT *Day 5 · demo day*

Pitched live, with families in the room

Judges from Harvard, Stanford, Y Combinator, and AI labs tested it before scoring.

Craft · finishing it well

Arena at the International School of Beijing, five-day student cohort, summer 2026. Photos from the ISB program; the quote is from the team's own demo-day slide

Work is changing faster, so start teaching children *the AI tools and skills that still matter.*

1

Work is changing faster

AI is already used in about half of all jobs

2

Fluency pays

Jobs that require AI skills pay 62% more

3

Start now, at home

Real projects with AI build the agency colleges and careers reward

When AI can make almost anything, students who choose, judge, and finish pull ahead.

Thank you. *Happy to take your questions.*

TODAY'S SLIDES

arenaschool.org/talk

TODAY'S SLIDES

arenaschool.org/talk

A PDF in English and Chinese, or read it on your phone.

TOOLS FROM THE PROGRAMS

arenaschool.org/case-study-examples

Step-by-step walkthroughs to open on your own time.

Questions after today? contact@arenaschool.org

Every figure in this talk comes from a *public 2025 or 2026 source.*

Anthropic, Economic Index: occupations using AI for at least 25% of tasks, 36% to 49%	*Jan 15, 2026*
Nature Medicine, the EyeFM randomized trial: 92.2% against 75.4%	*Aug 28, 2025*
Schwarcz, Manning, Prescott, and others, "AI-Powered Lawyering": 50% to 130%	*2026*
Caixin on the LexisNexis survey (93%); **NALP**, Class of 2025 (–7.5%)	*Aug 29, 2025 · Aug 5, 2026*
ICBC 2025 Annual Report: 55,000 person-years, 409,758 staff	*March 27, 2026*
Standard Chartered investor event; **The Guardian** on Bill Winters	*May 19 and 22, 2026*
Fortune and **Yahoo Finance** on Salesforce; **Google**, Sundar Pichai (75%); **SignalFire**, State of Talent	*May 2025 · April–May 2026*
界面新闻 citing 脉脉 on AI roles and basic developer hiring	*August 2025*
Business Insider on David Solomon, Goldman Sachs, at the Cisco AI Summit	*Jan 17, 2025*
Amazon: Andy Jassy memo; workforce memos (14,000 and 16,000 roles)	*June 2025–Jan 2026*
CNBC on Salesforce support (9,000 to about 5,000); **CNN** on Block	*Sept 2, 2025 · Feb 26, 2026*
Accenture Q4 fiscal 2025 earnings call; **Irish Times** on headcount	*Sept 25–26, 2025*
Business Insider on Julia Liuson's Microsoft email; **The Verge** on Duolingo's memo	*June 27, 2025 · April 28, 2025*
PwC, 2026 Global AI Jobs Barometer: 62% wage premium	*June 15, 2026*
Stanford Digital Economy Lab, "Canaries in the Coal Mine?", revised	*August 2026*
MyCOS 麦可思 survey of 3,794 university students, via 未来网	*April 16, 2026*

Where the figures on skills, schools, and tools *come from.*

Sundar Pichai, 75% of new Google code AI-generated and approved by engineers, up from 50% last fall	*April 22, 2026*
GitHub, Octoverse 2025: nearly 80% of new developers used Copilot in their first week	*2025*
World Economic Forum, Future of Jobs 2025, Figures 3.3 and 3.4: analytical thinking 69%, resilience 67%, leadership 61%, creative thinking 57%	*Jan 7, 2025*
Microsoft, 2026 Work Trend Index: checking AI's output (50%), critical thinking (46%); role shifting from generating answers to evaluating them	*Feb 18–April 7, 2026*
LinkedIn, Skills on the Rise 2026: leadership and people management rising with AI	*2026*
NACE, Job Outlook 2026 (13.3%) and Spring Update (35%)	*Nov 2025 · April 20, 2026*
解放日报, via 上观新闻, citing 智联招聘 on employer skills	*March 27, 2026*
央广网 on BOSS直聘 AI job postings (+74.1% in 2025)	*Jan 23, 2026*
北京市教育委员会, work plan for AI education (2025–2027), 京教办〔2025〕2号	*March 6, 2025*
中国教育科学研究院 survey of schools and teachers (88%, 54%); **Gallup** and **Walton Family Foundation** (68%)	*Aug 19, 2026 · 2025*
中国教育新闻网 on the teacher survey by 中国教育发展战略学会 and 学科网 (n=68,792)	*Oct 20, 2025*
METR, Time Horizon 1.1: 50% time horizon doubled about every 7 months; GPT-4 ~4 min, Claude 3.7 ~1 hour, Opus 4.5 ~5 hours	*Jan 29, 2026*
AI tools: Meta newsroom (Muse); TechCrunch (Instinct); Reuters (OpenClaw); manus.im, kimi.com, and each tool's own site	*2026 · checked Oct 11*
Hugging Face: 4,386 public models created Oct 12, 2026 (Hub API, UTC); 3,145,598 listed at huggingface.co/models	*checked Oct 13, 2026*
Kimi (Moonshot AI) hiring story, first-hand	*2026*
OECD, PISA 2025 results	*Sept 8, 2026*
Cursor: Series D post; Reuters, CNBC, and Bloomberg on SpaceX; SpaceX Form 8-K and PitchBook on the close	*Nov 2025 · June–Aug 2026*